

MICHELLE BLOMBERG

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Faculty, learning experience designer, and instructional technology leader with 25+ years in higher education spanning product management, platform strategy, curriculum design, and applied AI integration. Background combines early-career EdTech product management, district-level instructional technology leadership, and full-time faculty work designing and teaching UX, graphic design, and career readiness online. Current work centers on building AI-powered student and faculty tools, leading district-level AI integration focused on student success outcomes, and applying user-centered design and data-informed iteration to every layer of learning experience design.

EXPERIENCE

Residential Faculty, Digital Media Arts

2011–Present

Program Director, Digital Media Arts and Animation

2011–2022

Glendale Community College, Glendale, AZ

- Design and teach 15+ credit hours/semester of fully online courses in graphic design, UX, responsive web design, and career readiness; apply Canvas Analytics, Qualtrics dashboard analysis, and structured feedback loops to continuously iterate on learning design, treating courses as living products with measurable success criteria.
- Integrate AI tools actively into course design, instructional material development, and teaching practice; use Claude via LTI integration, Google NotebookLM, and BigInterview across active coursework.
- Advise 200+ students annually on academic planning, career pathways, portfolio development, and job search strategy; use PeopleSoft advising dashboard to identify at-risk patterns and intervene early.
- Serve as eCourses lead for the Art and Humanities department, supporting approximately 30 instructors; enforce Canvas proficiency and online pedagogy standards, conduct Quality Matters and OSCQR lead reviews, and coach faculty on evidence-based course improvement.
- Rebuilt program using industry advisory feedback; completion rates improved significantly, reaching the second-highest AAS graduation rate at Glendale Community College. Grew declared majors from 284 to 369.
- Co-wrote with colleagues and Dean to secure \$100K+ in grants for digital innovation labs (STEAMworks) tied to measurable student outcomes; documented in data-driven program reviews.
- Apply WCAG accessibility standards and inclusive design practices throughout all course and material development.
- Developed stackable Fast Track microcredential pathways for the Digital Media Arts and Animation programs using existing courses, providing students with industry-aligned credentials alongside the AAS degree.
- Curriculum proposal in development for AVC 2xx: UX Design for Interactive Media, a new course covering human-centered design process, user research, wireframing, prototyping, responsive web and mobile interface design, and AI-assisted design workflows; pending curriculum committee approval.
- Faculty Advisor, The Traveler Literary and Visual Arts Publication; art directed this nationally award-winning student publication.
- Designed and led ART280 Design Studio (2010–2023), cross-disciplinary capstone where students worked with real campus clients on live deliverables; relaunched January 2026 as a grant-funded paid professional studio.

Director of Instructional Technology

2004–2011

Glendale Community College, Glendale, AZ

- Led formal RFP evaluation and district-wide migration from Blackboard to Canvas for 250,000+ users across 10 Maricopa colleges; managed stakeholder alignment, change control, testing, and vendor relations across a highly complex governance environment.
- Served as district LMS committee co-chair representing all 10 Maricopa colleges; contributed to platform strategy, upgrade decisions, change control, and vendor relations for 250,000+ users.
- Established a single-point-of-contact instructional technology helpdesk using TeamDynamix; defined ITIL service level agreements, managed cross-functional development teams, and reduced resolution time. Recognized with Kudos Award, 2005.
- Defined requirements, created service agreements, and managed cross-functional development teams to deliver educational technology solutions on time and within budget.
- Established design standards, templates, and style guides for LMS course design, web interfaces, and digital communications across the college.
- Co-authored the proposal to establish GCC's Center for Teaching, Learning and Engagement (CTLE); benchmarked district models and recommended a faculty-led governance structure.
- Mentored instructors on active learning, hybrid course design, and technology-enhanced pedagogy; designed and facilitated faculty professional development workshops and in-services.

Online Learning Coordinator

2002–2004

University of Michigan Engineering School, Center for Professional Development, Ann Arbor, MI

- Managed quality assurance for one of the world's largest Six Sigma online programs; designed hyflex course structures (asynchronous, synchronous, and in-person) integrating video, audio, and interactive content.
- Supervised employees running video and sound production; maintained distance learning lecture capture facilities.
- Implemented organization-wide incident and request tracking system; wrote curriculum, conducted training, and administered follow-up assessments for all staff.

Product Manager, Higher Education

1999–2002

ProQuest Information and Learning, XanEdu Division (EdTech Startup), Ann Arbor, MI

- Managed end-to-end educational software product lifecycle: requirements documentation, usability studies, interface improvements, engineering collaboration, roadmap prioritization, and launch.
- Translated customer research and user feedback into structured product roadmaps; presented at national EdTech conferences to gather user input and drive adoption.
- Developed partner integrations with AOL, Blackboard, and WebCT; coordinated across engineering, sales, and marketing to align roadmap with customer and business goals.

Graphic Designer

1997–1999

Q LTD, Ann Arbor, MI

- Designed identity, web, and print campaigns for clients including University of Michigan Business School, SIGGRAPH, ProQuest, The Annenberg Foundation, and Ann Arbor Transportation Authority; managed client relationships, proposals, budgets, and vendor coordination.
- Contributed to large-scale web projects alongside the authors of Information Architecture for the World Wide Web (O'Reilly); participated in user research and usability studies pairing IA, design, and development.

ADJUNCT FACULTY

Glendale Community College, Art and Computer Information, Glendale, AZ

2005–2011

Designer's Toolbox: Dreamweaver (hybrid); Web Based Teaching and Learning (online, students were college faculty)

Washtenaw Community College, Internet Professional Program, Ann Arbor, MI

1999–2000

HTML; Web Site Fundamentals; Imaging for the Web; Advanced Imaging for the Web; Audio and Video for the Web

College for Creative Studies, Communication Graphics, Detroit, MI

1998–1999

Typography I; Typography II

Eastern Michigan University, Visual Communications, Ypsilanti, MI

1998–1999

Graphic Design I; Graphic Design II

SELECTED PROJECTS & CURRICULUM DESIGN

Render – AI Student Career Launch Platform (Prototype)

2026–Present

- Connectivist personal learning environment for final-semester students, built in conjunction with Career Services. Students actively construct their own career infrastructure rather than passively receiving content.
- Core modules: post-graduation study planning, curated industry news, resume version tracking, portfolio pipeline, self-promotion scheduling, networking tracking, and learning pathway recommendations.
- Built in HTML/CSS/Vanilla JS with Claude API integration; full PRD with user stories, skills taxonomy, success metrics, and data architecture. Usability testing March 2026; pilot planned Fall 2026.

Graphic Design History Presentation

2026

- A team research and presentation assignment spanning six eras of graphic design history (1895–1989); student pairs research an assigned time period using library databases, primary sources, and AI tools, then design and present to the class, with each group becoming the resident expert on their era.
- Students present using the visual language of their period, with typography, color, and layout that reflects the decade; tools include Miro, Prezi, Google Slides, or any presentation format they design from scratch. Recordings are posted to the class Discord so presentations remain accessible across cohorts.
- For extra credit, students are encouraged to vibe code an interactive learning tool using AI, building a slideshow, quiz, matching game, or timeline for their time period; they write a simple PRD before prompting, iterate with the AI, publish to Netlify or GitHub Pages, and document their process in Discord.
- Developed a working faculty demonstration for the extra credit path: a multi-page interactive slideshow and drag-and-drop artwork sorting game covering four design movements (1910–1920), built through AI prompting using public domain artworks, no manual coding.

- Demonstrates a replicable model for embedding AI fluency, information literacy, and interactive design into existing curriculum without requiring students to know how to code.

AVC100 Introduction to Digital Media – Course Redesign

2025–2026

- Contracted redesign of the department's highest-enrollment course, a 1-credit entry point with a documented low student success rate identified through Qualtrics dashboard analysis.
- Grounds every module in retention research: each module directly introduces student services (Advising, GCC Cares, Tutoring, Disability Services) as embedded learning design elements rather than peripheral resources.
- Grounded in psychological and behavioral research on belonging, self-efficacy, and early alert intervention; designed as a replicable wellness-embedded instructional design model for the department. Launching August 2026.

Digital Media Arts Discord Community

2020–Present

- Closed, 14-channel cross-program community connecting students across all DMA courses; students remain across semesters, creating genuine cross-cohort mentorship that Canvas discussion boards cannot replicate.
- Embedded Career Services job board, tutoring, and library support; expanding to Disability Services and Counseling. Career Services posts opportunities directly in a dedicated channel alongside faculty-curated listings.

SERVICE, COMMITTEES & PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

AI Resource Committee, Maricopa Community College District

2026–Present

Student Support & Success Co-Chair. Leading AI integration work focused on student success outcomes across a 10-college system. Authored proposal establishing a Campus-Wide AI Advisory Committee at Glendale Community College, submitted to college governance.

Online Educational Resources Committee, Glendale Community College

2023–Present

Maricopa OER initiatives have saved students over \$2 million in textbook costs.

eCourses Committee, Art Department Representative, Glendale Community College

2010–Present

eCourse Lead Reviewer (Quality Matters and OLC/OSCQR), Glendale Community College

2011–Present

Peer Assistance and Review Committee, Glendale Community College

2016–Present

PAR Mentor to three probationary faculty, 2016–2023.

Instructional Council, Art Program Curriculum Development, Maricopa Community Colleges

2010–2016, 2025–Present

HLC Accreditation Committee, Glendale Community College

2010–2012, 2020–2022

Criteria 3 and 5. Authored evidence for Teaching and Learning quality, CTE program outcomes, and institutional planning.

Guided Pathways Committee, Maricopa Community Colleges

2017–2019

Aligned curriculum across all 10 colleges; redesigned Arts and Humanities majors for cross-district consistency and workforce alignment.

eLearning Advisory Group, Maricopa Community Colleges

2004–2013, 2019–2020

Co-Chair 2009–2010. Represented 250,000+ users across the Maricopa system in platform strategy and instructional technology planning.

President's Technology Advisory Taskforce, Glendale Community College

2004–2010

Faculty Intranet Redesign Committee, Glendale Community College

2023–2024

UX evaluation, information architecture, and interface design as a practicing UX instructor.

EDUCAUSE Conference Session Submission Reviewer

2008–2010

EDUCAUSE Campus Representative, Glendale Community College

2005–2010

EDUCATION

Master of Education, Educational Technology

2017

Northern Arizona University, Flagstaff, AZ (online) | Adult online learning emphasis

Graduate research in connectivism and personal learning environments. Coursework: Research Methods in Education, Learning Theory and Design, Online Pedagogy, Assessment and Evaluation, Instructional Design, Research Ethics and IRB Compliance.

Blomberg, M. et al. (2017). *Education Transformed: How Open Network Learning and Personal Learning Environments are Changing the Way We Learn and Teach*. NAU. Collaborative graduate textbook on connectivist instructional technology practice.

Bachelor of Fine Arts, Visual Communications

1998

Eastern Michigan University, Ypsilanti, MI

DeProgram Dutch Design Program

Summer 1995

Eastern Michigan University | Netherlands and the United Kingdom

Continuing Education

Teaching AI Fluency Certificate (Anthropic Academy, 2026) • Prompt Engineering (Purdue University, 2024) • Applying the QM Rubric (Quality Matters)

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS & FACULTY DEVELOPMENT

From Classroom to Career: A Student Dashboard Built with AI May 2026
Mesa Community College AI Summit (forthcoming). 50-minute live demo presenting a replicable framework for AI-integrated career readiness built around a purpose-built student dashboard.

Online Learning Mentorship & Canvas Help for Art Faculty 2020–2022
Glendale Community College. Led emergency online transition support for 45+ art and humanities faculty during COVID; ongoing individual coaching throughout the pandemic.

eCourses Lunch & Learn Series 2015–2023
Glendale Community College. Ongoing faculty professional development on Canvas best practices, Bloom's Taxonomy rubric design, active learning, and retention strategies.

Successful Course Collaboration with Career Services, Library & Tutoring 2017
Glendale Community College. Cross-departmental session on integrating campus support services as intentional learning design elements.

STEAM Diaries: Quest to Build a Campus STEAM Program 2015
League for Innovation STEM Tech Conference, Phoenix; Maricopa Student Success Conference, Phoenix.

Planning for the Blackboard Content System 2007
Blackboard World Conference, Boston. District-wide rollout plan for Maricopa presented to a national audience.

Girls Exploring Technology 2005
Glendale Community College. Technology coordinator for annual one-day event for middle school girls covering hardware, 3D drawing, animation, and web design.

TOOLS & TECHNICAL

AI & Research: Claude (daily: prompt engineering, API integration, LTI), Google NotebookLM, ChatGPT, BigInterview

UX & Design: Figma, Miro, user journey mapping, persona development, wireframing, design thinking facilitation; Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, Premiere, After Effects, Captivate)

Prototyping: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript (vanilla), GitHub Pages, WordPress, Squarespace

Analytics & Data: Canvas Analytics, Qualtrics (survey design + dashboard), Tableau, PeopleSoft

Learning Platforms: Canvas LMS (administration, LTIs, Studio), Blackboard, SoftChalk, TeamDynamix, OER tools

Project & Collab: Notion, Slack, Discord (community administration), Basecamp, Microsoft Project

Accessibility: WCAG guidelines, ADA remediation workflows, Yuja Panorama, CidiLabs UDolt

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Gauche Globe Award for Open Educational Resources 2026
Glendale Community College

College Media Association Pinnacle Award, Literary Magazine of the Year 2015, 2016 & 2025
The Traveler, faculty advisor

Best of Phoenix Design Show, American Institute of Graphic Arts 2017–2022
The Traveler, faculty advisor

One Maricopa Award, Chancellor of Maricopa Community Colleges 2010
21st Century Maricopa Committee

One Maricopa Award, Chancellor of Maricopa Community Colleges 2009
Blackboard Testing Team

Kudos Award, Glendale Community College Technology Committee 2005